

Fore!

It's time to tee off with **Tiger Woods PGA Tour 06** in what is arguably the best game of golf you will ever play—indoors, that is!

First things first: I'm no good at golf. And playing this game for a period of about three weeks has further confirmed the belief that I perhaps never will be. Even against the computer. Why? Because *Tiger Woods PGA Tour 06* is just too realistic! If I wanted the wind to swerve away every drive, or bow to the whims and fancies of every putting green, I would go to a real golf course and not waste time trying to cheat the computer, would I? Oh well, call me geeky if you will, but I would, and I did!

Anyway, the fact that the game is too realistic is perhaps its greatest USP. In fact, I would go so far as to say that this game could even be enjoyed thoroughly by those who actually play the real thing. The physics is simply marvellous, and things like the angle at which your club hits the ball in the downswing also affect the final outcome of your shot.

Creating a player is one of the most enjoyable experiences of this game. Unfortunately, you can't upload your own photo to make it more realistic. What you can do, however, is choose his hair length, colour, cut style, clothes, shoes, glasses, cap, wrist band, height, weight, face characteristics, eyebrow length, size of the mole under your left eye and the weight around the midsection. I'm not kidding!

There is \$100,000 allotted to a pro-level player (if that's your choice of level) or \$10,000 to a novice to buy all the equipment and compete in the first year. Any earnings you make along the way are added, and this is used to determine your standing in the money list of the PGA Tour (or the Hacks Tour).



Create your player keeping the minutest detail in mind

There are many ways you can tee off and start playing. You could choose an existing player—anyone, from Arjun Atwal to Tiger Woods—and just get on the tour and compete with the best. Or, you could put your name on the scoreboard and risk losing some pride! Trust me, playing in this game, you will!

If you really want to get a hang of the game and learn the ropes, you can start as a novice and work your way up the local league (including friendly matches against office managers!) and earn your Tour Card.

Playing the game is easy, and you can choose from one of four available modes of hitting the ball—TrueSwing (Horizontal or Vertical), 2-Click and 3-Click. The TrueSwing modes are the best: they give you realistic control over how hard and accurately you hit the ball without having to keep track of rotating dials and power bars.

Player animation and the details on the golf courses (eight of them) are fantastic. One hitch here is that the player face (as seen on the scorecard) and the actual face (the one that is playing) don't match—a bug perhaps.

On the whole, though, if you like greens and have a strong heart, this is Rs 1,299 well spent.

A word of advice: Keep all warm beverages out of reach when playing, especially when teeing off! ☒

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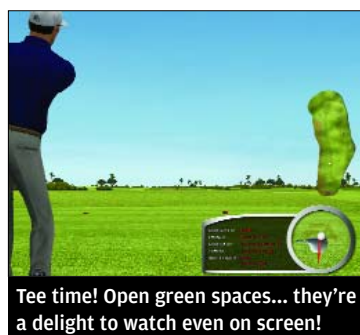
Publisher: EA Sports
Minimum System Configuration: Pentium III or Athlon 1 GHz, 256 MB RAM, 32 MB OpenGL Graphics Card, DirectX 9.0c compatibility
Price: Rs 1,299
Available in India through: Gayatri Impex



Your 'office' to plan and review your performance over the year



That's one of my better putts... and I can keep watching it forever



Tee time! Open green spaces... they're a delight to watch even on screen!



The year-long schedule of events. Choose the ones you want to play